

CIS241

System-Level Programming and Utilities

grep and wildcards

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Fall 2025

Based on material provided by Erin Carrier, Austin Ferguson, and Katherine Bowers

grep - pattern-matching search/filter

Usage: `grep string filename`

Common options:

- `-w`: Search only whole words
 - Removes partial matches, `-w abc` does not match `abcdef`
- `-r`: recursive (search files in directory)
- `-i`: ignore case
- `-n`: print line number

More with regex (later)

Wildcards

Probably have talked about these already, but formally...

Pattern matching for filenames!

- `*` - matches any number of characters
 - `ls *.txt`
- `?` - matches any single character
 - `ls data_?.csv`
 - Matches `data_7.csv` but not `data_17.csv`

Wildcards

- `[]` - character class or range
 - `[abc]`, `[a-z]`, `[:upper:]`, etc...
 - `[!a]` for complement
 - `ls [[:upper:]]*`
- This is all called globbing!
 - `man 7 glob`

<https://tldp.org/LDP/abs/html/globbingref.html>